

NYĀYA-VAIŚEṢIKA

REALIST SYSTEM MAP → SEVEN PADĀRTHAS → FOUR PRAMĀNAS AND PERCEPTION → INFERENCE ENGINE → CAUSATION AND ATOMISM → SELF, GOD AND LIBERATION

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g10 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 REALIST SYSTEM MAP

REALIST SYSTEM MAP VALID KNOWLEDGE AND ARGUMENT VAIŚEṢIKA INVENTORY OF REALITY NYĀYA-VAIŚEṢIKA REALISM + PLURALISM + LIBERATION THROUGH TRUTH PRAMĀ OBJECTS CORRECTLY KNOWN FALSE NOTIONS REMOVED FAULTS CEASE KARMA-PRODUCING ACTION CEASES REBIRTH AND PAIN CEASE

NYĀYA: valid knowledge and argument VAIŚEṢIKA: inventory of reality

NYĀYA-VAIŚEṢIKA realism + pluralism + liberation through truth pramā → objects correctly known → false

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- NYĀYA: valid knowledge and argument VAIŚEṢIKA: inventory of reality
- NYĀYA-VAIŚEṢIKA realism + pluralism + liberation through truth pramā → objects correctly known → false notions removed →

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- faults cease karma-producing action ceases → rebirth and pain cease → APAVARGA.
- NYĀYA: valid knowledge and argument VAIŚEṢIKA: inventory of reality

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- NYĀYA-VAIŚEṢIKA realism + pluralism + liberation through truth pramā → objects correctly known → false notions removed →
- faults cease karma-producing action ceases → rebirth and pain cease → APAVARGA.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): "Nyāya (the school of logic and valid knowledge) supplies the method of warranted cognition, while Vaiśeṣika (the school of categories and atomism) supplies the realist inventory that the later synthesis explains as one liberation-oriented system."

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): "Nyāya (the school of logic and valid knowledge) supplies the method of warranted cognition, while Vaiśeṣika (the school of categories and atomism) supplies the realist inventory that the later synthesis explains as one liberation-oriented system."

01

STAGE 01 SEVEN PADĀRTHAS

SEVEN PADĀRTHAS WHATEVER IS NAMEABLE AND KNOWABLE 1 DRAVYA EARTH, WATER, FIRE, AIR, ĀKĀŚA, TIME, SPACE, SELF, MIND 2 GUṆA QUALITY; DEPENDS ON SUBSTANCE, DOES NOT ITSELF POSSESS QUALITY/ACTION 3 KARMA MOTION/ACTION IN A SUBSTANCE

PADĀRTHA: whatever is nameable and knowable

1 DRAVYA: earth, water, fire, air, ākāśa, time, space, self, mind

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- PADĀRTHA: whatever is nameable and knowable
- 1 DRAVYA: earth, water, fire, air, ākāśa, time, space, self, mind
- 2 GUṆA: quality; depends on substance, does not itself possess quality/action

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- 3 KARMA: motion/action in a substance
- 4 SĀMĀNYA: real universal, one-in-many
- 5 VIŚEṢA: ultimate particularity individuating eternal atoms and selves

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- 6 SĀMAVĀYA: eternal inherence; whole-parts, universal-particular, quality-substance
- 7 ABHĀVA: absence — prior, posterior, mutual, absolute
- CAUTION: samavaya is not conjunction (samyoga), which is separable.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): "A padārtha (category or knowable referent) is a distinct kind of reality required to classify what exists, what qualifies or moves it, how it is related, and how its absence is known."

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): "A padārtha (category or knowable referent) is a distinct kind of reality required to classify what exists, what qualifies or moves it, how it is related, and how its absence is known."

02

STAGE 02 FOUR PRAMĀNAS AND PERCEPTION

FOUR PRAMĀNAS AND PERCEPTION SENSE-OBJECT CONTACT SAVIKALPAKA RECOGNITION SIGN (LINGA/HETU) THROUGH VYĀPTI TO SĀDHYA KNOWLEDGE THROUGH SIMILARITY AND PRIOR DESCRIPTION TRUSTWORTHY UTTERANCE, ULTIMATELY ĀPTA TESTIMONY PERCEPTION TYPES ORDINARY/ĀLAUKIKA ĀLAUKIKA

pratyakṣa: sense-object contact → nirvikalpaka → savikalpaka recognition

anumāna: sign (linga/hetu) through vyāpti to sādhyā

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- pratyakṣa: sense-object contact → nirvikalpaka → savikalpaka recognition
- anumāna: sign (linga/hetu) through vyāpti to sādhyā
- upamāna: knowledge through similarity and prior description

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- śabda: trustworthy utterance, ultimately āpta testimony
- PERCEPTION TYPES: external/internal
- ordinary/ālaukika ālaukika: sāmānyalakṣaṇa, jñānalakṣaṇa, yogaja

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ERROR is mislocation of a real qualifier: anyathākhyāti.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): "A pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge) is a reliable causal route to true cognition, and Nyāya defends inference by grounding vyāpti (invariable concomitance) through observation, removal of hidden conditions and tarka (hypothetical reductive reasoning)."

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): "A pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge) is a reliable causal route to true cognition, and Nyāya defends inference by grounding vyāpti (invariable concomitance) through observation, removal of hidden conditions and tarka (hypothetical reductive reasoning)."

03

STAGE 03 INFERENCE ENGINE

INFERENCE ENGINE INFERENCE FOR ONESSELF DEMONSTRATED TO ANOTHER FIVE MEMBERS 1 PRATJĪNA HILL HAS FIRE 2 HETU BECAUSE IT HAS SMOKE 3 UDĀHARANA

SVĀRTHĀNUMĀNA: inference for oneself

PARĀRTHĀNUMĀNA: demonstrated to another five members

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SVĀRTHĀNUMĀNA: inference for oneself
- PARĀRTHĀNUMĀNA: demonstrated to another five members
- 1 pratijñā: hill has fire

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- 2 hetu: because it has smoke
- 3 udāharana: wherever smoke, fire — as kitchen
- 4 upanaya: hill has such smoke

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- 5 nigamana: therefore hill has fire pakṣadharmatā + vyāpti + uncontradicted application → conclusion
- HETVABHĀSA: savyabhicāra, viruddha, satpratipakṣa, asiddha, bādhita.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — 5 nigamana: therefore hill has fire pakṣadharmatā + vyāpti + uncontradicted application → conclusion

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: therefore hill has fire pakṣadharmatā + vyāpti + uncontradicted application → conclusion.

04

STAGE 04 CAUSATION AND ATOMISM

CAUSATION AND ATOMISM EFFECT IS A NEW BEGINNING, NOT PRE-EXISTENT AS EFFECT SAMAVĀYI (INHERENT) ASAMAVĀYI (NON-INHERENT) NIMITTA (EFFICIENT) EARTH/WATER/FIRE/AIR PARAMĀṆU GROSS COMPOSITE PRALAYA

COMPOSITES DISSOLVE: ETERNAL ATOMS, SELVES, SPACE, TIME REMAIN SBṢṬI ĪŚVARA ACTIVATES ATOMS ACCORDING TO ADṢṬA/KARMA

ASATKĀRYAVĀDA / ĀRAMBHĀVĀDA: effect is a new beginning, not pre-existent as effect causes: samavāyī (inherent)

asamavāyī (non-inherent)

nimitta (efficient) earth/water/fire/air paramāṇu → dyad → triad → gross composite pralaya: composites dissolve

eternal atoms, selves, space, time remain sṛṣṭi: īśvara activates atoms according to adṛṣṭa/karma

TRAP: God orders atoms; God is not the material cause and atoms are not created

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ASATKĀRYAVĀDA / ĀRAMBHĀVĀDA: effect is a new beginning, not pre-existent as effect causes: samavāyī (inherent)
- asamavāyī (non-inherent)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- nimitta (efficient) earth/water/fire/air paramāṇu → dyad → triad → gross composite pralaya: composites dissolve
- eternal atoms, selves, space, time remain sṛṣṭi: īśvara activates atoms according to adṛṣṭa/karma

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- TRAP: God orders atoms; God is not the material cause and atoms are not created ex nihilo.
- ASATKĀRYAVĀDA / ĀRAMBHĀVĀDA: effect is a new beginning, not pre-existent as effect causes: samavāyī (inherent)

MECHANISM / VERDICT — God orders atoms; God is not the material cause and atoms are not created ex nihilo.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God orders atoms; God is not the material cause and atoms are not created ex nihilo.

05

STAGE 05 SELF, GOD AND LIBERATION

SELF, GOD AND LIBERATION ETERNAL, MANY, ALL-PERVASIVE SUBSTRATE OF COGNITION, DESIRE AND VOLITION ATOMIC INNER SENSE LINKING SELF TO ONE COGNITION AT ETERNAL OMNISCIENT EFFICIENT CAUSE; AUTHOR/TEACHER OF VEDA

COORDINATES ATOMS AND KARMIC DESERTS WITHOUT ABOLISHING INDIVIDUAL AGENCY DOṢA REMOVED PRAVRṬTI CEASES KARMA EXHAUSTED

ĀTMAN: eternal, many, all-pervasive substrate of cognition, desire and volition

MANAS: atomic inner sense linking self to one cognition at a time

ĪŚVARA: eternal omniscient efficient cause; author/teacher of Veda

coordinates atoms and karmic deserts without abolishing individual agency true knowledge → doṣa removed →

classical Nyāya does not define it as Brahman-union.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ĀTMAN: eternal, many, all-pervasive substrate of cognition, desire and volition
- MANAS: atomic inner sense linking self to one cognition at a time

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ĪŚVARA: eternal omniscient efficient cause; author/teacher of Veda
- coordinates atoms and karmic deserts without abolishing individual agency true knowledge → doṣa removed → pravṛtti ceases →

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- classical Nyāya does not define it as Brahman-union.
- ĀTMAN: eternal, many, all-pervasive substrate of cognition, desire and volition

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (CORE ARGUMENT): "Udayana's case is strongest cumulatively; the world as effect, atomic arrangement, cosmic support, linguistic convention and moral order converge upon īśvara (the omniscient Lord) as intelligent efficient—not material—cause."

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (CORE ARGUMENT): "Udayana's case is strongest cumulatively; the world as effect, atomic arrangement, cosmic support, linguistic convention and moral order converge upon īśvara (the omniscient Lord) as intelligent efficient—not material—cause."

06

STAGE 06 PROOF, OBJECTION AND COMPARISON

PROOF, OBJECTION AND COMPARISON UDAYANA ROUTES KĀRYĀT (EFFECT) ĀYOJANĀT (COMBINATION) DHṚTYĀDEH (SUPPORT) PADĀT (WORD-USE) PRATYAYATAH (TRUST) ŚRUTEH (VEDA) VĀKYĀT (SENTENCES) SAMKHYĀVĪŚEṢĀT (NUMBER)

SĀMKHYA: satkāryavāda, prakṛti material cause

NYĀYA: new effect from atoms

BUDDHISM: momentary process

NYĀYA: enduring substances and selves.

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- UDAYANA ROUTES: kāryāt (effect)
- āyojanāt (combination)
- dhṛtyādeh (support) padāt (word-use)
- pratayayatah (trust)
- śruteh (Veda)

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- vākyāt (sentences) samkhyāviśeṣāt (number)
- adṛṣṭāt (moral order)
- OBJECTION: atoms + karma may make God redundant; bodies expose unequal suffering
- REPLY: unconscious atoms/adṛṣṭa cannot intelligently initiate and allocate order
- SĀMKHYA: satkāryavāda, prakṛti material cause

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- NYĀYA: new effect from atoms
- BUDDHISM: momentary process
- NYĀYA: enduring substances and selves.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): "Āsatkāryavāda or ārambhavāda (the theory that production begins a previously non-existent effect) preserves novelty, while eternal atoms preserve material continuity through ordered combination."

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): "Āsatkāryavāda or ārambhavāda (the theory that production begins a previously non-existent effect) preserves novelty, while eternal atoms preserve material continuity through ordered combination."

07

STAGE 07 PYQ ANSWER SPINE

PYQ ANSWER SPINE DEFINE REALIST-PLURALIST SYNTHESIS LIST SEVEN CATEGORIES WITH RELATIONS FOUR PRAMĀNAS PERCEPTION STAGES FIVE-MEMBER INFERENCE ĪŚVARA PROOFS AND OBJECTION ĀRAMBHĀVĀDA + THREE CAUSES

DEFINE realist-pluralist synthesis → list seven categories with relations

four pramānas → perception stages → five-member inference

anyathākhyāti → self/manas → īśvara proofs and objection

ārambhavāda + three causes → atomistic creation cycle

apavarga → compare Sāmkhya/Buddhism → qualified verdict

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEFINE realist-pluralist synthesis → list seven categories with relations
- four pramānas → perception stages → five-member inference
- anyathākhyāti → self/manas → īśvara proofs and objection

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ārambhavāda + three causes → atomistic creation cycle
- apavarga → compare Sāmkhya/Buddhism → qualified verdict
- VERDICT: the system gains explanatory integration from realism and logical method

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- its pressure points are inference, the leap from order to God, and austere liberation.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: the system gains explanatory integration from realism and logical method;

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: the system gains explanatory integration from realism and logical method;

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE ALL LAYER 3 MATERIAL FROM THE LEGACY IT SHOULD REFINE A CORE ANSWER, NOT DISPLACE THE LAYER 3 - ADVANCED ADVANCED UNITY AND HISTORICAL QUALIFICATION THAN ONE UNDIFFERENTIATED DOCTRINE.

THEIR LATER SYNTHESIS IS A DIVISION OF LABOUR NYAYA CONTRIBUTES PRAMANA THEORY, INFERENCE AND DIALECTIC, WHILE VAISESIKA

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Layer-placement note
- Layer-placement note All Layer 3 material from the legacy complete session is retained here after practice.
- It should refine a core answer, not displace the printed syllabus.
- LAYER 3 - ADVANCED Advanced unity and historical qualification Historically, Nyaya and Vaisesika begin as distinguishable schools rather

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- than one undifferentiated doctrine.
- Their later synthesis is a division of labour: Nyaya contributes pramana theory, inference and dialectic, while Vaisesika contributes
- padarthas, atomism, visesa and samavaya.
- Navya-Nyaya then sharpens the shared analytic vocabulary.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- This system is realist in three linked senses.
- Objects exist independently of cognition
- valid cognition can disclose them
- and even error is explained through misrelation among real factors rather than by reducing the world to appearance.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.